

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1213

By Doggett

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Richland High School Lady Raiders basketball team upon winning the 2026 TSSAA Division I, Class A state championship.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly should salute those student athletes who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as true champions of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such exemplary group is the Lady Raiders girls' basketball team of Richland High School, whose members have proven themselves to be the fiercest of competitors and truly worthy of admiration by winning the 2026 TSSAA Division I, Class A state championship; and

WHEREAS, in the championship game, the Lady Raiders prevailed over Middleton in a heroic struggle that will be remembered forever in the Richland community, winning by a score of 34-33 to claim the Gold Ball trophy that signifies a state champion and finish their 2025-2026 campaign with an outstanding 28-3 record; and

WHEREAS, this year marks the first state championship in program history for the Richland Lady Raiders, with their victory in the "Glass House" in Murfreesboro following on the heels of their District 9A and Region 5A championships and their Sectional victory that punched their ticket to the state tournament; and

WHEREAS, Lady Raiders Baylee Hollis, Bailey Blair, Alizabeth Gordon, and Dannie Lynn Galloway were named to the Class A All-State Tournament team, with Ms. Blair being named the Most Valuable Player; and

WHEREAS, no strangers to awards and accolades, all five seniors on the Richland Lady Raiders girls' basketball team were named to the Basketball Coaches Association of Tennessee

All-District Academic Team; these seniors finish their high school careers having compiled ninety-nine victories over the past four years; and

WHEREAS, the members of this championship basketball team are Alizabeth Gordon, Bailey Blair, Baylee Hollis, Caroline Cheek, Dannie Lynn Galloway, Halle Grace Bratton, Hudsyn Miller, Kate Kirk, Khloe McConnell, Lauren Blair, Lilly Lancaster, Lily Loveless, Lorelei Helton, Mary Avery McNeese, Mary Cam Gordon, Mary Katherine Butler, Mylee Dunavant, and Sissy Randolph; and

WHEREAS, bringing the energy and school spirit to every game for the Lady Raiders this season were the Richland High School cheerleaders: Abbi Watts, Adalee Nelson, Addie Kirkpatrick, Aniston Gordon, Aubreeah Helton, Aurelia Risner, Brayden Norris, Breanna Birdsong, Cameron Jackson, Caroline Jackson, Caydence Dunavant, Claire Taylor, Courtney Curran, Emma Gibson, Gabby Braden, Grayson Williams, Holley Wise, Jack Curry, Jaycee Lane, Kailynne Hawkins, Kaylee Hall, Kylie Jo Kennedy, Krysten Hood, Langston Norris, Lauren Cunningham, Leah Costello, Peyton McCrary, Ryah Greene, and Tenley Rose; and

WHEREAS, Richland's superb performance would not have been possible without the expert guidance of basketball coaches Chad Hall, Matt Miller, Tammy Holt, and Henlee Mitchell and cheerleading coaches Beth Hall and Holly Gibson; the commitment of team photographer/manager Jolie Robison; and the unfailing support of the players' families, their fans, and their community; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Richland Lady Raiders basketball team epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, the perseverance, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young women not only made possible a championship but also surely bode well for their future success; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the Richland Lady Raiders for their historic season on the hardwood; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the players, coaching staff, team support staff, administrators, cheerleaders, and fans of the Richland High School Lady Raiders girls' basketball team upon winning the 2026 TSSAA Division I, Class A state championship, and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.